Manuel Schick

PhD Candidate, Heidelberg University · Postdoctoral Researcher, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam

manuel.schick@awi.uni-heidelberg.de | +49 6221 54 2908 | Alfred Weber Institute for Economics
Room 01.020, Bergheimer Str. 58, 69115 Heidelberg, Germany

Homepage | GitHub | LinkedIn | SSRN

Research Interests

Macroeconomic forecasting, density and tail risk modeling, survey expectations, econometrics, empirical finance.

Education

Grades reported on the German scale (1.0 = highest, 4.0 = lowest passing grade).

09/2020–08/2026 **PhD in Economics**, Heidelberg University
Chair of Econometrics, Alfred Weber Institute for Economics

09/2020–08/2021 **Visiting PhD Student**, University of Mannheim
Center for Doctoral Studies in Economics (CDSE)
First-year PhD coursework: Mathematics, Microeconomics, Macroeconomics, Econometrics I–III (GPA: 1.5)

10/2017 – 08/2020 **M.Sc. Economics and Finance**, University of Tübingen
Thesis: "Indirect Inference Estimation of Stochastic Volatility Models using Neural Networks" (GPA: 1.1)

10/2013 – 03/2017 **B.Sc. Economics and Business Administration**, University of Tübingen (GPA: 1.7)

Academic Positions

10/2026 – 04/2027 **Postdoctoral Researcher**, Chair of Econometrics, Heidelberg University

02/2026 – 09/2026 **Postdoctoral Researcher**, Finance Department, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam

09/2020 – 01/2026 **PhD Candidate**, Chair of Econometrics, Heidelberg University

04/2020 – 08/2020 **Tutor**, Chair of Statistics, Econometrics and Quantitative Methods, University of Tübingen

10/2018 – 03/2020 **Tutor**, Chair of Econometrics, Statistics and Empirical Economics, University of Tübingen

10/2017 – 08/2020 **Student Assistant**, Institute for Applied Economic Research (IAW), Tübingen

05/2017 – 09/2017 **Intern**, Mergers & Acquisitions, Daimler AG

02/2017 – 04/2017 **Intern**, Institute for Applied Economic Research (IAW), Tübingen

Working Papers

Job Market Paper — **"Nowcasting Growth-at-Risk using the Survey of Professional Forecasters"**
Keywords: Tail Risk, Density Forecasts, GARCH, Real-Time Data
Available on SSRN

with Anne Opschoor — **"Multivariate Economic Tail Risk and Scenario Analysis using the Survey of Professional Forecasters"**
Keywords: Growth-at-Risk, Multivariate Predictive Densities, GARCH, Tail Risk, Macroeconomic Forecasting
Available on SSRN

Work in Progress

with Friederike Becker — **"Implied Quarterly Forecasts from Annual Projections in the ECB Survey of Professional Forecasters"**

- Recovers quarterly fixed-horizon GDP growth forecasts from annual fixed-event projections in the ECB Survey of Professional Forecasters using a Kalman filter and smoother.
- Applies the approach at both the consensus and individual level, yielding a cross-section of implied forecasts without look-ahead bias.
- Implied consensus forecasts outperform standard time-series benchmarks at short horizons, exhibiting underreaction, while individual forecasts show signs of overreaction.

with Anne Opschoor — **"Forecasting 10-Day-Ahead Portfolio Value-at-Risk and Expected Shortfall: Univariate, Multivariate, and Copula Approaches"**

- Basel regulations require banks to forecast 10-day-ahead Value-at-Risk (VaR) and Expected Shortfall (ES) for their trading portfolios.
- We compare a wide range of volatility models, including multivariate and copula-based approaches, evaluating predictive accuracy via the joint loss function of Fissler and Ziegel (2016) as well as formal backtesting procedures.
- Simple copula-based models estimated at the asset level perform best, outperforming both more complex multivariate volatility models and univariate benchmarks applied directly to portfolio returns.

Conferences & Talks

2026

July — **13th HKMetrics Workshop**, Karlsruhe Institute of Technology, Germany

June — **2026 IAAE Annual Conference**, Nova School of Business and Economics, Lisbon, Portugal

June — **Econometrics Department Brownbag**, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam, Netherlands

April — **3rd CESA Workshop for Young Researchers**, FernUniversität in Hagen, Germany *(invited talk)*

March	**Finance@VU Lunch Seminar**, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam, Netherlands

2025

November	**Workshop on Macro- and Financial Econometrics**, Örebro University, Sweden
September	**Verein für Socialpolitik (VfS) Annual Conference**, University of Cologne, Germany
June	**12th HKMetrics Workshop**, ZEW Mannheim, Germany

2024

September	**Society of Financial Econometrics (SoFiE) Summer School**, National Bank of Belgium, Brussels, Belgium
May	**Departmental Seminar**, Department of Economics, Heidelberg University, Germany
April	**Financial Econometrics & Macroeconomic Expectations Workshop**, Heidelberg University, Germany

2023

July	**10th HKMetrics Research Network Workshop**, Karlsruhe Institute of Technology, Germany
June	**Macro & Econometrics Workshop**, Heidelberg University, Germany

2022

December	**16th International Conference on Computational and Financial Econometrics**, London, United Kingdom

Teaching

Lectures

Winter 26/27	**Advanced Econometrics**, Heidelberg University (Master)
Winter 22/23–24/25	**Preparatory Course: Advanced Econometrics**, Heidelberg University (Master)

Tutorials

Winter 20/21–25/26	**Advanced Econometrics**, Heidelberg University (Master)
Winter 24/25	**Advanced Macroeconomics**, Heidelberg University (Master)
Summer 23, 25	**Financial Econometrics**, Heidelberg University (Master)
Summer 22	**Empirische Wirtschaftsforschung**, Heidelberg University (Bachelor)
Summer 21, 24	**Makroökonometrie**, Heidelberg University (Bachelor)
Winter 19/20	**Quantitative Methoden der Wirtschaftswissenschaften**, University of Tübingen (Bachelor)
Summer 19, 20	**Wahrscheinlichkeit und Risiko**, University of Tübingen (Bachelor)
Winter 18/19	**Explorative Datenanalyse**, University of Tübingen (Bachelor)

Academic Service

09/2024	Discussant, "Assessing the Ex-Ante Uncertainty in the US-SPF" by Malte Knüppel and Lora Pavlova, ZEW-FMT Workshop

Skills

Languages	German (native), English (fluent, written and spoken)
Software	LaTeX(advanced), MS Office (intermediate)
Statistical Software	Stata (advanced), MATLAB (advanced), R (intermediate), Gauss (intermediate), SAS (beginner)

References

Prof. Dr. Christian Conrad
Chair of Econometrics
Heidelberg University
christian.conrad@awi.uni-heidelberg.de

Dr. Anne Opschoor
Associate Professor, Department of Finance
Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam
a.opschoor@vu.nl

Prof. Dr. Timo Dimitriadis
Professor of Econometrics
Goethe University Frankfurt
dimitriadis@econ.uni-frankfurt.de